

ANIME

86

★★★★☆ | Action anime come and go and they're nothing new to the anime industry. In fact, the Big 3 - Naruto, One Piece and Hunter x Hunter all have one thing in common. They are primarily action anime. Another thing with the genre is that it is often associated with the 'shounen' genre - anime geared towards young men or boys. But rarely comes an anime which is action and is not shounen. The anime that we were watching through the weekend is '86'. Yes, the title of the anime is a number. This anime is the perfect amalgamation of action, disparity, emotions and grief. The anime revolves around The Republic of San Mongolia which has 85 core districts where it's residents reside. Usually, whenever the word 'Racism' comes, it generally means 'discriminating on



the basis of skin color' but here, in the Republic of San Mongolia, it is different. People are discriminated against on the basis of the color of their hair. Only those with silver hair are treated as people. Rest all are considered pigs. Then comes along the main character of the story Vladilena Milize who is

assigned to the Spearhead Squadron consisting of the '86'. The soldiers who are treated as pigs. The soldiers who fight for the country and keep them safe and we're not even getting started on the whirlpool of emotions you will feel while watching the show.

The only negative thing about this anime is the simultaneous presence of some very good action scenes with decent animation and the lack of action all together. It's just that the action and the MC - Shinei Rouzen has the ability to fight so well but still most of the fight scenes leave you wanting for just another minute of it. The anime emphasizes on the uncertainty of life. The person that you cherish the most they may be alive and fighting right beside you and another moment, they're gone. There is much more to the story than what meets the eye. The story and the plot deepens as you progress through the episodes and almost all the episodes and especially the ending is sure to make you cry.

—Kshira Jadav

TV SHOW

Marvel's What If... ?

★★★★☆ The series lives up to its name smartly by making choices at the heart of the story, making the audience question dozens of "What Ifs" even as it shows one of them playing out. Sure Agent Carter gets to be the first Avenger, but it is totally possible that it might have been Howard Stark! The action is so fast and furious that there is barely enough time to contemplate these questions because you get to behold the awesomeness that is Buff Peggy. The op notch animation allows us to see familiar situations and people in a new light. The equation between Peggy and Steve switches, with skinny Steve being as supportive to Buff Peggy as OG Peggy was to Steve. It is all compelling enough to convince



you that this is in fact, the better story. There is an extremely pleasant surprise for those who do not know it yet, the final performance of Chadwick Boseman as T'Challa. We get to see the epic GOTG introduction scene by James Gunn for the third time in the MCU, only this time around, Korath does not give

a confused "Who?" when T'Challa introduces himself as a Star Lord, instead becoming a fanboy going OMG, along with the audience. This episode is just hilarious. The series serves as a great introduction to the multiverse that we are sure to see in the MCU. The important thing here is that the universe may be different because of other people's choices, but the underlying urges of what makes these heroes who they are, are the same. This is apparent in Carina and Good Guy Thanos who is still absolutely genocidal! Black Star Lord does try to put the Happy Mad Titan through therapy with his daughter so it is all good. If there is a negative, then it is all too convenient. Yondu is kind, loving and considerate, as he would be after all his experiences, in the Marry Poppins stage at the end of the world. Thanos is post genocidal before the genocide, argued into tending to plants by Mr. King, Black Star Lord. We will knock off a star for Boseman, because T'Challa took to the skies.

—Aditya Madanapalle